TASK 3: FRONT WHEEL ALIGNMENT AND STEERING GEOMETRY CHECKS

Autocare Technician Level 2 | Block 4 | v2.1

TIME	EVIDENCE	PROGRAMME POINT
60 minutes	**Practical | Knowledge | Documentation**	**Weeks 31-40**

Your task

A customer reports uneven tyre wear and the steering wheel is off-centre. You must carry out alignment pre-checks, record geometry readings and explain whether adjustment or further repair is required.

What you must do

1. Prepare the vehicle and alignment equipment safely.
2. Carry out pre-checks including tyre pressure, tyre condition and suspension condition.
3. Measure alignment readings and compare with manufacturer data.
4. Adjust if instructed and within competence, or explain referral/action required.
5. Record findings and reinstate the vehicle/workstation.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE SETUP

Suitable PPE, a prepared work area and controlled vehicle or equipment.

CORRECT METHOD

A logical sequence using the relevant procedure and technical information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE

Actual readings, findings and actions recorded clearly and precisely.

SOUND DECISIONS

Appropriate recommendations, referral or authorisation supported by evidence.

You will need

- Light vehicle
- Wheel alignment equipment
- Tyre pressure gauge and tread depth gauge
- Manufacturer geometry data
- PPE and Apprentice Assessment Record

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 4 - Emerging Technology and Driveline Systems
Duties: 1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 KSB evidence focus: K16-K20, S10-S13, B1, B2
Task reference: Block_4_Task_3_Front_Wheel_Alignment

TASK 3: FRONT WHEEL ALIGNMENT AND STEERING GEOMETRY CHECKS

Practical record

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

TASK COMPLETED AT

○ **APPRENTICE'S WORKPLACE**

○ **TRAINING CENTRE**

Vehicle make

Model

Registration

Mileage

Engine size / type

VIN / chassis number

Measurements and technical checks

Front toe measured		Front toe specification	
Camber measured		Camber specification	
Caster measured		Rear toe/thrust angle	
Tyre pressures		Ride height/pre-check result	

Special tools, equipment or calibration requirements

Task evidence

PPE and precautions used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, findings and recommendations

Knowledge check

1. Why are tyre pressures checked before alignment?

2. What effect can incorrect toe have on tyre wear?

Knowledge check - continued

3. (a) Why should suspension condition be checked before adjustment? (b) What does thrust angle indicate?

4. How would you explain alignment findings to a customer?

5. (a) When should alignment not be adjusted immediately? (b) What evidence should be retained from the alignment task?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- ☐ Carry out wheel alignment pre-checks safely.
- ☐ Record camber, caster and toe readings where equipment allows.
- ☐ Identify whether readings are within manufacturer specification.
- ☐ Explain the relationship between geometry and tyre wear.
- ☐ Record findings and customer recommendations.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

○ **PASS** ○ **REFER**

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and decision are accurate.

Apprentice name	Assessor/Workplace Mentor name	PIN (if applicable)
Apprentice signature	**Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature**	**Date**